



CODEFORGE

Complete Earning & Deployment Guide

Step-by-step guide to monetize your website with ads, deploy on Vercel for free, and start earning real money. Zero budget required.

FOR BILAL • MAY 2025 • ZERO BUDGET STRATEGY

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Quick Summary: This guide covers everything from how ad networks pay you, to signing up, adding ad code, deploying the website, getting traffic, and receiving your first payment. Follow each step in order.

01 - How Ezoic Earning Works

Basic Concept: How Websites Earn from Ads

When someone visits your website, ads are shown on the page. Advertisers pay money to show their ads to your visitors. The ad network (like Ezoic) takes a small commission and gives you the rest. This is how every ad-supported website earns money - from blogs to YouTube to news sites.



Key Terms You Must Know

CPM (Cost Per Mille / Cost Per 1000 Impressions)

This is how much an advertiser pays for 1000 ad views. If CPM is 5, it means for every 1000 times the ad is shown, the advertiser pays 5. Developer/tech content typically has CPM between 3 to 15, which is higher than entertainment or gaming content.

RPM (Revenue Per 1000 Pageviews)

This is how much YOU earn per 1000 page views. RPM is usually higher than CPM because each page has multiple ad slots. If your page has 4 ads and each has 3 CPM, your RPM could be around 8-12 after the ad network's commission.

EPMV (Earnings Per Thousand Visitors) - Ezoic's Metric

Ezoic uses EPMV instead of RPM because it measures earnings per visitor, not per pageview. This is more accurate because one visitor might view 3 pages. If EPMV is 10 and you get 1000 visitors, you earn 10. Ezoic's EPMV for tech sites is typically 8 - 25.

How Much Money Can You Earn?

Here is a realistic earning estimate for CodeForge (developer tools + blog website):

Monthly Visitors	Page Views (avg 2.5 pages/visit)	EPMV (estimated)	Monthly Earning
1,000	2,500	\$8	\$8
5,000	12,500	\$10	\$50
10,000	25,000	\$12	\$120
25,000	62,500	\$14	\$350
50,000	125,000	\$16	\$800
100,000	250,000	\$18	\$1,800

Important: These are realistic estimates, not guarantees. Actual earnings depend on your traffic source, geographic location of visitors (US/UK traffic pays more), content quality,

and ad placement. Pakistani traffic pays less than US traffic, but developer content attracts global visitors which pays better.

Ezoic vs AdSense Comparison

Feature	Ezoic	Google AdSense
Approval Time	1-3 days	2-6 weeks
Minimum Traffic Required	None (0 visitors OK)	Not specified but needs active site
Minimum Payout	\$20	\$100
Payment Method	PayPal, Payoneer, Wire	Wire, EFT, Check
Earnings (Tech sites)	50-200% more than AdSense	Baseline
AI Optimization	Yes (auto ad placement)	No (manual placement)
Ad Quality	Premium advertisers	Mixed quality
Best For	New sites wanting fast monetization	Established sites with 10K+ traffic

Why Ezoic is best for you: Ezoic approves in 1-3 days, has no minimum traffic requirement, pays more than AdSense for tech content, and has a low \$20 minimum payout. You can start earning within your first week!

How Ezoic Pays You - The Complete Flow

1 Sign Up on Ezoic

Create account at ezoic.com. No traffic requirement. You need a live website with some content (which CodeForge already has - 7 blog posts + 6 tools + all legal pages).

2 Ezoic Reviews Your Site (1-3 Days)

Ezoic team checks your site for content quality, policy pages (Privacy, Terms, Disclaimer - which you already have), and original content. They approve most developer tool sites quickly.

3 Connect Your Site

Ezoic gives you integration options: NameServer integration (easiest) or WordPress plugin. For Next.js on Vercel, you will use their JavaScript integration or Cloudflare integration.

4 Ads Start Showing

Once connected, Ezoic automatically places ads on your site. Their AI tests different ad positions, sizes, and types to find what earns the most. This optimization takes 2-4 weeks to reach full potential.

5 Earnings Accumulate

Every visitor who sees ads generates revenue. Ezoic tracks everything in their dashboard. You can see real-time earnings, traffic data, and EPMV metrics.

6 Get Paid (Monthly)

Ezoic pays monthly, net 30 days. January earnings are paid by end of February. Minimum payout is \$20. Payment via PayPal (easiest for Pakistan) or Payoneer or wire transfer.

PayPal in Pakistan: Pakistan does not officially support PayPal receiving. Use Payoneer instead - it works perfectly in Pakistan and can withdraw to your local bank account (JazzCash, EasyPaisa, or any bank). Sign up at payoneer.com for free.

02 - Ad Network Signup Process

Recommended Strategy: Start with Adsterra, Upgrade to Ezoic

Best Plan: Apply to Adsterra first (instant approval) to start earning immediately. Then apply to Ezoic simultaneously. Once Ezoic approves, switch to Ezoic for higher earnings. You can also apply to Media.net as a backup.

A. Adsterra Signup (Fastest - Instant Approval)

1 Go to [adsterra.com](https://www.adsterra.com)

Visit <https://www.adsterra.com> and click "Sign Up" or "Start Earning". Select "Publisher" account type (you are a website owner showing ads, not an advertiser).

2 Fill in Your Details

Enter your name, email, and website URL (your Vercel domain like `codeforge.vercel.app`). Select payment method (choose Payoneer or Wire Transfer). Adsterra accepts Pakistani publishers.

3 Get Your Zone IDs (Instant)

After signup, go to Dashboard > Add Website > Create Ad Zone. Create these zones:

- Banner 728×90 (for horizontal ads) → Copy the Zone ID
- Native Ad (for in-article ads) → Copy the Zone ID
- Social Bar / Sticky (for mobile) → Copy the Zone ID

4 Put Zone IDs in `.env.local`

Add your Zone IDs to the environment variables (explained in Section 03). Your ads will start showing within minutes!

B. Ezoic Signup (Highest Earning)

1 Go to [ezoic.com](https://www.ezoic.com)

Visit <https://www.ezoic.com> and click "Get Started". Ezoic offers a free tier called "Access Now" that has no minimum traffic requirement.

2 Enter Your Website URL

Enter your deployed website URL (e.g., `codeforge.vercel.app`). Ezoic will scan your site for compliance - policy pages, original content, no prohibited content.

3 Wait for Approval (1-3 Days)

Ezoic reviews your site. CodeForge has everything they need: original blog posts, working tools, Privacy Policy, Terms & Conditions, Disclaimer, About page. Approval rate is very high for developer sites.

4 Get Your Ezoic Site ID

After approval, go to Ezoic Dashboard > Settings. You will find your Site ID. Copy this and add it to your `.env.local` file as `NEXT_PUBLIC_EZOIC_SITE_ID`.

5 Choose Integration Method

For Next.js on Vercel, choose "Cloudflare Integration" or "DNS Integration". Ezoic will walk you through connecting your domain. If using `.vercel.app` domain, use Ezoic's JavaScript tag integration instead.

C. Media.net Signup (Backup Option)

1 Go to media.net

Visit <https://www.media.net> and apply. Media.net is Yahoo! and Bing's ad network. They prefer sites with some traffic (even 500 visitors/month is enough). Approval takes 2-5 days.

2 Get Your CID

After approval, you get a CID (Customer ID) from the dashboard. Add it to `.env.local` as `NEXT_PUBLIC_MEDIANET_CID`.

03 - Ad Code Setup in CodeForge

Environment Variables Configuration

CodeForge already has ad components built in. You only need to configure which ad network to use by setting environment variables. This is done without changing any code.

Step 1: Create .env.local file

In your project root folder, create a file named `.env.local` :

```
# Which ad network to use: "adsterra" or "ezoic" or "medianet" or "none"
NEXT_PUBLIC_AD_NETWORK=adsterra

# ---- ADSTERRA (Start with this) ----
NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSTERRA_BANNER_ID=your_banner_zone_id_here
NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSTERRA_NATIVE_ID=your_native_zone_id_here
NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSTERRA_STICKY_ID=your_sticky_zone_id_here

# ---- EZOIC (Upgrade to this later) ----
NEXT_PUBLIC_EZOIC_SITE_ID=your_ezoic_site_id_here

# ---- MEDIA.NET (Backup option) ----
NEXT_PUBLIC_MEDIANET_CID=your_medianet_cid_here
```

Step 2: Replace with your real IDs

After signing up on Adsterra/Ezoic, replace the placeholder values with your actual IDs. For example, if Adsterra gives you Banner Zone ID `1234567` , set:

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSTERRA_BANNER_ID=1234567
```

Step 3: Restart the development server

Environment variables only take effect after restarting the server. Stop the current server and run again:

```
npm run dev
```

Ad Placement Locations in CodeForge

Your website already has 10 strategic ad placements. Here's where they are:

Location	Page	Ad Type	Performance
After Tools Section	Home Page	Horizontal Banner	High
After Blog Section	Home Page	Horizontal Banner	High
Bottom of Home	Home Page	Horizontal Banner	Medium
Top of Blog Post	Blog Post	Horizontal Banner	Very High
Middle of Blog Post	Blog Post	In-Article Ad	Highest Earning
Bottom of Blog Post	Blog Post	Horizontal Banner	Medium
Blog Sidebar	Blog Listing	Sidebar Ad	High
Bottom of Blog Listing	Blog Listing	Horizontal Banner	Medium
Bottom of Tools Page	Tools Page	Horizontal Banner	Medium
Mobile Sticky Bottom	All Pages (Mobile)	Sticky Banner	Very High

Best earning placements: In-article ads (middle of blog posts) and mobile sticky ads are the highest earners. Blog posts attract readers who spend more time on page, which means

more ad revenue.

Switching Between Ad Networks

To switch from Adsterra to Ezoic, simply change the environment variable:

```
# Change from Adsterra to Ezoic  
NEXT_PUBLIC_AD_NETWORK=ezoic
```

That's it! The ad components will automatically switch to Ezoic code. No other code changes needed.

04 - Deploy on Vercel (Free Hosting)

Complete Deployment Steps

1 Install Git

Download and install Git from <https://git-scm.com>. After installation, open terminal and set your identity:

```
git config --global user.name "BILAL"
git config --global user.email "your-email@gmail.com"
```

2 Create GitHub Account

Go to <https://github.com> and create a free account. Use the same email you used in Git config. Verify your email address.

3 Upload Code to GitHub

Open terminal in your project folder and run these commands:

```
cd /path/to/your/codeforge-project

# Initialize git repository
git init

# Add all files
git add .

# Create first commit
git commit -m "Initial commit - CodeForge website"

# Create GitHub repository first at github.com/new
# Then connect and push:
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/codeforge.git
git branch -M main
git push -u origin main
```

4 Sign Up on Vercel (Free)

Go to <https://vercel.com> and click "Sign Up". Choose "Continue with GitHub" to connect your GitHub account. This is 100% free - no credit card needed.

5 Import Your Project

On Vercel dashboard, click "Add New" > "Project". Select your `codeforge` repository from the list. Vercel will auto-detect Next.js framework. Click "Deploy" - that's it! Your site will be live in 2-3 minutes.

6 Get Your Live URL

Vercel gives you a free URL like `codeforge.vercel.app` or `codeforge-xyz123.vercel.app`. This is your live website! Anyone in the world can visit it now.

7 Add Environment Variables on Vercel

Go to your project on Vercel > Settings > Environment Variables. Add all the variables from your `.env.local` file:

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_AD_NETWORK = adsterra
NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSTERRA_BANNER_ID = your_zone_id
NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSTERRA_NATIVE_ID = your_zone_id
NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSTERRA_STICKY_ID = your_zone_id
```

After adding, click "Redeploy" for changes to take effect.

8 Custom Domain (Optional - Free with Freenom or Cheap with Namecheap)

For a professional look, connect a custom domain like `codeforge.dev` or `codeforge.tools` . On Vercel: Settings > Domains > Add. You can buy cheap domains from Namecheap (\$1-3/year for .xyz, .site domains). Free .tk/.ml domains were discontinued, so a cheap domain is the best option.

Every time you update code: Just push to GitHub with `git add . && git commit -m "update" && git push` , Vercel automatically rebuilds and deploys your site within 1-2 minutes!

How to Update the Website

Whenever you want to make changes (new blog post, new tool, etc.):

```
# 1. Make your changes in the code
# 2. Save files
# 3. Push to GitHub:
git add .
git commit -m "Added new blog post"
git push
```

Vercel automatically detects the changes and redeploys your site. No manual deployment needed!

05 - Traffic Strategy (Free Methods)

Why Traffic = Money

More visitors means more ad views, which means more earnings. If you get 1000 visitors/month with 10*EPMV*, *you earn 10 EPMV*, *you earn 10*/month. If you get 10,000 visitors, you earn \$100/month. The key is to get traffic without spending money. Here are proven free methods.

Method 1: SEO - Search Engine Optimization (Best Long-Term)

Your developer tools are your biggest SEO advantage. People search Google for "image compressor online", "json formatter", "password generator" thousands of times daily. Each tool page can rank on Google and bring daily visitors automatically.

SEO Keywords Your Tools Target

Image Compressor: "compress image online", "reduce image size", "image compressor free" - 50K+ monthly searches

JSON Formatter: "json formatter", "json beautifier", "json validator" - 100K+ monthly searches

Password Generator: "password generator", "secure password", "random password" - 200K+ monthly searches

Word Counter: "word counter", "character counter online" - 80K+ monthly searches

Color Picker: "color picker", "hex to rgb converter" - 60K+ monthly searches

CSS Gradient Generator: "css gradient generator", "gradient maker" - 30K+ monthly searches

SEO Timeline: Google takes 3-6 months to start ranking new sites. Be patient! Write more blog posts (2-3 per week) to speed this up. Each blog post is another page that can rank on Google.

Method 2: Social Media (Fastest Initial Traffic)

Platform	What to Post	How Often	Expected Traffic
Facebook Groups	Share tools in web dev groups	Daily	20-50 visits/day
Twitter/X	Tips + tool links	2-3 times/day	10-30 visits/day
Reddit	Helpful answers + tool links	2-3 times/week	50-200 visits/post
Pinterest	Code snippets as images	3-5 pins/day	20-50 visits/day
LinkedIn	Developer articles	2-3 times/week	10-30 visits/day

Method 3: YouTube Shorts (Viral Potential)

Create 30-60 second Shorts showing your tools in action. For example: "Generate a secure password in 5 seconds" showing your Password Generator. Link to your website in the description and comments. YouTube Shorts can go viral and bring hundreds of visitors from a single video.

Method 4: Quora & Stack Overflow

Answer questions on Quora about web development topics. When someone asks "How to format JSON data?", answer with helpful content and mention your JSON Formatter tool as a bonus. This brings highly targeted traffic that stays longer (which means more ad revenue).

Daily 30-Minute Traffic Plan

Morning (10 minutes)

Share one tool on 2-3 Facebook developer groups. Post a tip on Twitter with a link to your blog.

Afternoon (10 minutes)

Answer 1-2 questions on Quora with a link to your tools. Pin a code snippet on Pinterest.

Evening (10 minutes)

Share on Reddit (webdev, javascript subreddits). Engage with comments on your posts.

06 - Earning Calculator & Timeline

Month-by-Month Projection

Month	What You Do	Expected Traffic	Expected Earning
Month 1	Deploy site, apply for Adsterra, share on social media daily	200-500 visitors	\$2-5
Month 2	Apply to Ezoic, write 4 more blog posts, continue social sharing	500-1,500 visitors	\$5-15
Month 3	Switch to Ezoic, SEO starts working, write more blog posts	1,500-3,000 visitors	\$15-30
Month 4	Ezoic optimization kicks in, tools rank on Google	3,000-5,000 visitors	\$30-50
Month 5	More blog posts, YouTube Shorts, Pinterest traffic	5,000-8,000 visitors	\$50-80
Month 6	SEO ranking improves, consistent traffic from Google	8,000-15,000 visitors	\$80-150
Month 9	Multiple tools ranking, blog getting organic traffic	20,000-40,000 visitors	\$200-500
Month 12	Established authority site, passive income	40,000-80,000 visitors	\$400-1,000+

Realistic Expectations: First 2-3 months earnings will be very small (

2 – 15/month). *This is normal! Every successful website starts this way. The key is to keep posting content and sharing. After 6 months, if you consistently post 2 – 3 blog posts per week and share daily, you should be earning 80-150/month.*

After 12 months with consistent effort, \$500-1000/month is achievable.

When Will You Get Your First Payment?

Adsterra Payment

Minimum payout: 5(Net 15 days). *If you earn 5 (Net 15 days).* If you earn 5 in January, you get paid by February 15th. Payment via Payoneer, Wire, or Crypto (USDT). **Fastest to first payment!**

Ezoic Payment

Minimum payout: 20(Net 30 days). *If you earn 20 (Net 30 days).* If you earn 20 in January, you get paid by end of February. Payment via PayPal or Payoneer. **Higher earnings per visitor.**

Media.net Payment

Minimum payout: \$100 (Net 30 days). Higher threshold but good for backup. Payment via Wire Transfer.

How to Receive Payment in Pakistan

1 Sign Up for Payoneer (Free)

Go to <https://www.payoneer.com> and create a free account. Payoneer gives you a virtual US bank account that can receive payments from ad networks. Upload your CNIC for verification.

2 Link Payoneer to Ad Network

In Ezoic/Adsterra dashboard, go to Payment Settings and select Payoneer. Enter your Payoneer account details. This only needs to be done once.

3 Withdraw to Pakistani Bank

Payoneer lets you withdraw to any Pakistani bank account (HBL, UBL, Meezan, etc.) or JazzCash/EasyPaisa. Conversion rate is competitive. Money arrives in 1-3 business days.

07 - Important Tips & Warnings

NEVER Do These Things (Will Get You Banned)

1. Never click your own ads! This is the #1 reason accounts get banned. Ad networks have sophisticated click-fraud detection. Even one self-click can flag your account. Tell friends and family NOT to click ads either - ad networks detect this easily.

2. Never ask others to click ads! Writing "Please click on ads to support us" or "Support by clicking ads" anywhere on your site will get you banned from ALL ad networks. This violates every ad network's terms of service.

3. Never use bot traffic or paid traffic! Buying cheap traffic from Fiverr or using traffic bots will get you banned. Ad networks want real human visitors who are genuinely interested in your content. Only use the free organic methods described in this guide.

4. Never put too many ads! More ads does NOT mean more money. Too many ads make visitors leave (bounce rate increases) and ad networks may penalize you. CodeForge already has optimal ad placement - do not add more.

5. Never copy content from other sites! Duplicate content gets penalized by Google (no SEO traffic) and rejected by ad networks. Always write original content or heavily rewrite in your own words.

Things You SHOULD Do

Write 2-3 Blog Posts Per Week

Every blog post is a new page that can rank on Google. Topics: JavaScript tips, CSS tricks, React tutorials, web dev career advice. Aim for 800-1500 words per post. More content = more traffic = more earnings.

Share Every New Post on Social Media

When you publish a new blog post or tool, share it on at least 3-4 platforms. This creates initial traffic signals that help Google discover and rank your content faster.

Focus on English Content

English content earns 5-10x more than Urdu content because advertisers pay more for US/UK/Europe audiences. Write everything in English. You can add Urdu later as a secondary language.

Be Patient - It Takes Time

Every successful earning website took 6-12 months to become profitable. The first 3 months will feel slow. Keep posting, keep sharing, and the traffic will come. SEO compounds over time - month 6 will be much better than month 1.

Monitor Your Analytics

Add Google Analytics (free) to track your visitors. Also use the Ezoic/Adsterra dashboard to see which pages earn the most. Double down on what works - if a specific tool gets more traffic, create similar tools.

Quick Action Checklist

#	Task	Status
1	Deploy website on Vercel	
2	Sign up for Adsterra	
3	Add Adsterra Zone IDs to Vercel env vars	
4	Redeploy on Vercel	
5	Verify ads are showing on live site	
6	Sign up for Ezoic	
7	Sign up for Payoneer	
8	Share website on 5+ Facebook groups	
9	Create Twitter/X account for CodeForge	
10	Write first new blog post	
11	Add Google Analytics	
12	Answer 5 Quora questions with tool links	

Final Note: You have everything you need to start earning. The website is built, the ad system is ready, the tools are working, and the blog has content. Now it's up to you to deploy, sign up for ads, and consistently drive traffic. Every journey starts with a single step - deploy your site today!